

you get a load of Palm's offering. The WebOS, for us, was love at first sight.

In a demonstration video, the WebOS was faster, slicker, better-looking and seemed more user-friendly than any operating system we have seen. One of the most talked-about features is its ability to multi-task, running several applications at the same time without slowing down the device. The iPhone, as you may know, does not support multi-tasking apart from a few select tasks.

The ability of the WebOS to multi-task so effectively lies in its construction itself. While Windows Mobile and other operating systems require programming languages such as C++ to develop applications, Palm has based its platform on basic Web development tools such as CSS, HTML and Javascript. This makes the applications a lot less resource-hungry and a lot faster to run.

The reliance on such simple languages has also made the WebOS a hit among the developer community, which has noted that it is the easiest major phone platform to code on. Hopefully, this means we will see a lot of applications when it comes around.

Operating systems, as we noted earlier, are more than just an add-on for phones and computers. In the end, they define the user's interaction with the device and his entire experience. And going by the demonstrations of the WebOS and the reactions it has received, this could just be the bigger competitor that the iPhone has had. Let's just hope Palm's marketing wing is as good as its developers team when it comes to taking on Apple.

3.3 - Bluetooth 3.0

When it comes to wireless connectivity between two devices, especially mobile phones, Bluetooth is the de facto standard used. It is installed in almost every portable computing device, is reliable, and offers good transfer speeds.

In fact, a lot of television sets, computer motherboards, car stereos and other non-conventional devices are equipped with Bluetooth now. Increasing one's control over gadgets using the handy mobile phone seems to be the norm.